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(12) **United States Plant Patent**
van Sambeek

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(54) **PHLOX PLANT NAMED ‘DOPHLFLAMA’**

(50) Latin Name: *Phlox paniculata*
Varietal Denomination: **Dophlflama**

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(NL)

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(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this
patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

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30, 2019.

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A01H 5/02 (2018.01)

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(52) **U.S. Cl.**

USPC **Plt./320**

CPC **A01H 6/70** (2018.05)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**

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CPC **A01H 5/02**

See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant named ‘Dophl-
flama’, characterized by its upright and uniform plant habit;
vigorous growth habit; early and freely flowering habit;
dense inflorescences with purple-colored flowers with
lighter purple-colored centers; and good garden perfor-
mance.

1 Drawing Sheet

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Botanical designation: *Phlox paniculata*.
Cultivar denomination: ‘DOPHLFLAMA’.

**CROSS-REFERENCED TO CLOSELY RELATED
APPLICATIONS**

Title: Varieties of *Phlox* Plants
Inventor: Ellen van Sambeek
Applicant: Dümmen Group B.V.
Provisional application Ser. No. 62/973,349
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Inventor and Applicant hereby claim the benefit of this
provisional U.S. Patent Application.

**STATEMENT REGARDING PRIOR
DISCLOSURES BY INVENTOR &
APPLICANT/ASSIGNEE**

An European Community Plant Breeder’s Rights appli-
cation for the instant plant was filed by the Applicant/
Assignee, Dümmen Group B.V. of De Lier, The Netherlands
on Sep. 19, 2019, application number 2019/2283. Foreign
priority is not claimed to this application.

The Inventor and Applicant/Assignee assert that no pub-
lications nor advertisements relating to sales, offers for sale
or public distribution occurred more than one year prior to
the effective filing date of this application. Any information
about the claimed plant would have been obtained from a
direct or indirect disclosure from the Inventor and/or Appli-
cant/Assignee. Inventor and Applicant/Assignee claim a
prior art exemption under 35 U.S.C. 102(b)(1) for disclosure
and/or sales prior to the filing date but less than one year
prior to the effective filing date.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Phlox* plant, botanically known as *Phlox paniculata* and
hereinafter referred to by the name ‘Dophlflama’.

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The new *Phlox* plant is a product of a planned breeding
program conducted by the Inventor in Aalsmeer, The Neth-
erlands. The objective of the breeding program was to create
new early and freely-flowering *Phlox* plants with attractive
flower color.

The new *Phlox* plant originated from a cross-pollination
made by the Inventor in July, 2013 in Aalsmeer, The
Netherlands, of a proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata*
identified as code number PA06-000105-001, not patented,
as the female, or seed, parent with a proprietary selection of
Phlox paniculata identified as code number PA-0049, not
patented, as the male, or pollen, parent. The new *Phlox* plant
was discovered and selected by the Inventor as a single
flowering plant from within the progeny of the stated
cross-pollination in a controlled environment in Aalsmeer,
The Netherlands in July, 2014.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Phlox* plant by vegeta-
tive cuttings in a controlled environment in Aalsmeer, The
Netherlands since March, 2015 has shown that the unique
features of this new *Phlox* plant are stable and reproduced
true to type in successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Plants of the new *Phlox* have not been observed under all
possible combinations of environmental conditions and cul-
tural practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat with
variations in environmental conditions such as temperature
and light intensity without, however, any variance in geno-
type.

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
are determined to be the unique characteristics of ‘Dophl-

flama'. These characteristics in combination distinguish 'Dophlflama' as a new and distinct *Phlox* plant:

1. Upright and uniform plant habit.
2. Vigorous growth habit.
3. Early and freely flowering habit.
4. Dense inflorescences with purple-colored flowers with lighter purple-colored centers.
5. Good garden performance.

Plants of the new *Phlox* differ primarily from plants of the parent selections in plant habit as plants of the new *Phlox* are more uniform than plants of the parent selections.

Plants of the new *Phlox* can be compared to plants of *Phlox paniculata* 'Sweet Summer Snow', not patented. In side-by-side comparisons, plants of the new *Phlox* and 'Sweet Summer Snow' differ in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Phlox* are more compact than plants of 'Sweet Summer Snow'.
2. Plants of the new *Phlox* have shorter leaves than plants of 'Sweet Summer Snow'.
3. Plants of the new *Phlox* are more freely flowering than plants of 'Sweet Summer Snow'.
4. Plants of the new *Phlox* flower about two weeks earlier than plants of 'Sweet Summer Snow'.
5. Plants of the new *Phlox* and 'Sweet Summer Snow' differ in flower color as plants of the new *Phlox* have purple-colored flowers with lighter purple-colored centers whereas plants of 'Sweet Summer Snow' have white-colored flowers.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPH

The accompanying colored photograph illustrates the overall appearance of the new *Phlox* plant showing the colors as true as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproductions of this type. Colors in the photograph may differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical description which accurately describe the colors of the new *Phlox* plant.

The photograph comprises a side perspective view of typical flowering plant of 'Dophlflama' grown in a container.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photograph and following observations, measurements and values describe plants grown during the early summer in 17-cm containers initially in a glass-covered greenhouse and finished in an outdoor nursery in Aalsmeer, The Netherlands and under cultural practices typical of commercial *Phlox* production. During the production of the plants, day temperatures averaged 21° C. and night temperatures averaged 15° C. Plants were pinched one time one week after planting rooted young plants and were eleven weeks old when the photograph and the description were taken. In the following description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 2001 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

Botanical classification: *Phlox paniculata* 'Dophlflama'.

Parentage:

Female, or seed, parent.—Proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata* identified as code number PA06-000105-001, not patented.

Male, or pollen, parent.—Proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata* identified as code number PA-0049, not patented.

Propagation:

Type.—By vegetative cuttings.

Time to initiate roots, summer.—About 16 days at temperatures about 26° C.

Time to initiate roots, winter.—About three weeks at temperatures about 23° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, summer.—About 24 days at temperatures about 23° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, winter.—About four weeks at temperatures about 18° C.

Root description.—Thick, fibrous; typically white in color, actual color of the roots is dependent on substrate composition, water quality, fertilizer type and formulation, substrate temperature and physiological age of roots.

Rooting habit.—Moderately freely branching; medium density.

Plant description:

Plant and growth habit.—Herbaceous perennial typically grown as a container and garden plant; upright and uniform plant habit; vigorous growth habit and rapid growth rate.

Plant height.—About 37 cm.

Plant width (spread).—About 40 cm.

Lateral branches.—Branching habit: About three lateral branches develop after pinching. Length: About 34 cm. Internode length: About 5.5 cm. Strength: Strong. Aspect: Mostly upright. Texture: Smooth, glabrous. Color: Close to 143B; at the nodes, tinged with close to 187A.

Leaf description:

Arrangement.—Opposite, simple.

Length.—About 8.5 cm.

Width.—About 4 cm.

Shape.—Ovate to elliptical.

Apex.—Cuspidate to acute.

Base.—Acute.

Margin.—Entire, finely ciliate.

Texture, upper surface.—Slightly rough; fine pubescence.

Texture, lower surface.—Smooth, glabrous.

Venation pattern.—Pinnate, reticulate.

Color.—Developing and fully expanded leaves, upper surface: Close to 137A; venation, close to 138A. Developing and fully expanded leaves, lower surface: Close to 137C; venation, close to 139D.

Petioles.—Length: About 3 mm. Diameter: About 3 mm. Strength: Strong, flexible. Texture, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous. Color, upper surface: Close to 144A. Color, lower surface: Close to 139D.

Flower description:

Flower type and flowering habit.—Single rotate and salverform flowers arranged in compound terminal and lateral panicles; flowers face mostly upright to outwardly depending on position on inflorescence; freely flowering habit with about 30 to 40 flowers per inflorescence and about 590 flowers developing per plant during the flowering season.

Fragrance.—Slightly fragrant, pleasant.

Natural flowering season.—Early flowering habit, plants begin flowering about ten weeks after planting; plants flower in July in the garden in The Netherlands; flowers not persistent.

Flower buds.—Height: About 2.7 cm. Diameter: About 6 mm. Shape: Conical. Color: Close to 82A.

Inflorescence height.—About 23 cm.

Inflorescence diameter.—About 21 cm.

Flower diameter.—About 3.5 cm.

Flower depth.—About 2.5 cm.

Flower throat diameter.—About 4 mm.

Flower tube length.—About 1.5 cm.

Flower diameter, proximally.—About 3 mm.

Petals.—Quantity per flower: Typically five in a single whorl; Petals fused at the base into a narrow tube. Lobe length: About 1.5 cm. Lobe width: About 1.8 cm. Lobe shape: When flattened, round. Lobe apex: Rounded. Lobe margin: Entire. Lobe texture, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous. Throat texture: Pubescent. Tube texture: Pubescent. Color: When opening and fully opened, upper surface: Close to 80A; towards throat, close to 80B; venation, close to 80A; color becoming closer to 80B with development. When opening and fully opened, lower surface: Close to 82A; venation, close to 82A; color does not change with development. Throat: Close to 77A; venation, close to 77A. Tube: Close to 77A; venation, close to 77A.

Sepals.—Quantity per flower: Typically five in a single whorl, fused towards the base; calyx, campanulate. Length: About 1.1 cm. Width: About 2 mm. Shape: Narrowly deltoid. Apex: Acuminate. Margin: Entire. Texture, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous. Color: When opening and fully opened, upper surface: Close to 145A; at the apices, close to 187A. When opening and fully opened, lower surface: Close to 137A.

Peduncles.—Length: About 13 cm. Diameter: About 4 mm. Strength: Moderately strong. Aspect: About 45° from lateral branch axis. Texture: Smooth, glabrous. Color: Close to 143C.

Pedicels.—Length: About 1.5 cm. Diameter: About 2 mm. Strength: Moderately strong. Aspect: About 45° from peduncle axis. Texture: Smooth, glabrous. Color: Close to 143C.

Reproductive organs.—Stamens: Quantity per flower: Typically five. Filament length: About 2 mm. Filament color: Close to 155C. Anther length: About 2 mm. Anther color: Close to 1B. Pollen amount: Abundant. Pollen color: Close to 155B. Pistils: Quantity per flower: One. Pistil length: About 2.1 cm. Stigma shape: Cleft, three-parted. Stigma color: Close to 150A. Style length: About 1.7 cm. Style color: Close to 64A. Ovary color: Close to 144A.

Seeds and fruits.—To date, seed and fruit development have not been observed on plants of the new *Phlox*.

Garden performance: Plants of the new *Phlox* have been observed to have good garden performance and to tolerate rain, wind and temperatures ranging from −20° C. to 35° C.

Pathogen & pest resistance: To date, plants of the new *Phlox* have not been observed to be resistant to pathogens and pests common to *Phlox* plants.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Phlox* plant named ‘Dophlflama’ as illustrated and described.

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